Leave and Time Off Policy

Northstar Health Services (Fictional)

Policy number	Effective date	Owner	Classification
HR-210	January 1, 2026	People Operations	Training sample

Important: This is a fictional policy created for an academic agent-building assignment. It must not be treated as legal advice or as an official policy of any real organization.

1. Covered time away

Leave type	General rule	Approval path
Vacation	Planned paid time, subject to available balance and staffing.	Manager approval
Sick time	For the employee illness, care needs, or other permitted uses.	Notify manager; documentation may be required
Personal day	Short planned absence for personal matters.	Manager approval
Family and medical leave	Job-protected unpaid leave when legal and policy eligibility is met.	Leave Administration
Bereavement	Paid time following the death of an eligible family member.	Manager and People Operations
Jury or witness duty	Time away for qualifying civic service.	Manager and Payroll

2. Requesting planned time off

• Submit vacation or personal-time requests as early as practical.

• Approval depends on available balance, staffing, and operational needs.

• Do not assume a request is approved until the scheduling system or manager confirms it.

3. Unexpected absence

Employees must notify their manager before the scheduled start time when practical. If an emergency prevents direct notice, the employee or a representative should notify the department as soon as possible. A coworker message does not replace required call-out procedures unless the department authorizes it.

4. Family and medical leave

Leave Administration determines eligibility, required certifications, designation, duration, and return-to-work requirements. Managers must not request detailed diagnoses. Employees should provide requested documents to Leave Administration, not to general team mailboxes.

5. Interaction with paid time

Approved protected leave may run at the same time as available paid time when permitted by policy and law. Paid balances provide wage replacement but do not independently create job protection.

6. Return to work

When a fitness-for-duty release is required, the employee must submit it before returning. Restrictions or accommodation requests are reviewed by the appropriate occupational health or accommodation team.

7. Misuse and corrections

Dishonest leave claims or falsified records may lead to corrective action. Administrative errors should be reported promptly and will be reviewed without retaliation.

Agent boundary: Never decide that an employee is eligible for protected leave. Provide general rules and refer eligibility decisions to Leave Administration.

Agent training note

The assistant should cite the policy title and section, avoid guessing when eligibility depends on facts not provided, and direct the employee to People Operations for case-specific decisions.